

4.4.9 Sampling Rate

The conversion of analogue signals into digital format involves taking samples of the sound track at regular intervals and converting this into digital data. The Sampling rate is the frequency of the sampling or the number of samples taken per second. The greater the samples taken, the lesser the data lost in the conversion. CD Audio uses a 44.1 KHz sampling rate, that is, 44,100 samples per second.

4.4.10 Stereo

An audio stream that contains two data channels of data, one each for the left and right perspective, would be called stereo.

4.4.11 Surround Sound

This refers to multichannel sound where there are at least four discrete sound channels, representing the front left, front right, back left and back right channels. Surround sound can also comprise a larger number of channels.

4.4.12 Wavetable Synthesis

A Wavetable refers to the set of sample sounds of different instruments stored on the sound card. The use of the Wavetable to create and store sounds is called Wavetable Synthesis. Since the contents of the Wavetable varies with sound card, the composition need not sound the same on all systems.

4.4.13 WAV

WAV is a file format for uncompressed audio data.

4.4.14 Virtual Surround

Normal surround systems employ at least four speakers to create a spatial effect. Modern sound cards can create a similar effect with two speakers using advanced algorithms that can process the multichannel audio source to identify the “spatialness” and create an approximation by altering the stereo output. This is called Virtual Surround. While the totality of the “surroundness” can be achieved, the fidelity that is achieved with surround speakers cannot be duplicated. The reverse of the process is also seen, wherein